

Philipp Hilbert. *Payments PM for a high-growth MENA Fintech.*

Positioning, payments product manager with a founded-and-exited P2P payments company, a decade of regulated-industry delivery, and hands-on funnel and SQL analytics.

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§ WHY NAMELESS VENTURES

A payments-focused PM role at one of the fastest-growing Fintech businesses in the MENA region is precisely where domain depth compounds fastest: the region's payment infrastructure is still being built, which means routing decisions, provider cascades, and recovery flows have outsized leverage on conversion. The explicit emphasis on deposit conversion, withdrawal performance, and failed-payment recovery maps directly to the work I did at Kvitt Payment Solutions, where I owned the full P2P funding and disbursement journey from zero to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem. The preference for crypto-exchange or neobank backgrounds fits: I have spent eight years actively trading across CEX and DEX venues and studying execution quality, slippage, and payment routing at a level most PMs never need to. *That combination of hands-on payments history and deep market-structure intuition is exactly what the deposit funnel needs.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case drafting
- **Cursor / VSCode**, code-context navigation and review
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair-programming and test scaffolding
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, research synthesis and stakeholder-deck drafting

- **Gamma.app**, async stakeholder communication
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
 - **Framer**, design-heavy prototypes and investor decks
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

PostgreSQL, SQL, Python, REST APIs, Kotlin (Spring Boot), MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both firm and worker until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, reducing onboarding friction to near zero.
 - LLM agent layer across the funnel, one operator runs the full day-to-day with no headcount.
 - Funnel and conversion tracking in SQL, the same analytical discipline this payments role demands.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT NAMELESS VENTURES

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the deposit and withdrawal flows end to end, pull the funnel data in SQL, and map every payment provider's success and failure rates by segment before forming any opinions.

WEEK 2

Slice the funnel.

Instrument the highest-drop-off step, define one clear metric for success, and scope the smallest experiment that would confirm or kill the hypothesis.

WEEK 3+

Ship, close loops.

Land the first improvement in production, feed learnings back into the routing and retry logic, and establish the weekly payment-performance review cadence with Engineering, Finance, and Compliance.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Product Manager, Payments role. My interest is grounded in specifics: I founded and ran Kvitt Payment Solutions, a mobile group-based P2P payments product built from scratch and ultimately acquired by Sparkasse to operate inside the girocard ecosystem. Owning that product meant owning the full customer funding journey, onboarding, account funding, disbursements, failed-payment handling, and every edge case in between. That experience is the direct antecedent of what this role asks for.

Beyond the founding experience, I have spent eight years as an active participant in crypto markets, including perpetual futures trading on Hyperliquid, spot execution on CEX and DEX venues, and cross-chain bridging via protocols like Across and 1inch. I work regularly with liquidation heatmaps and execution analytics on platforms such as Coinglass and Hyblock Capital, and I study routing, slippage, price impact, and market microstructure as a practical discipline. The posting's preference for backgrounds in crypto exchanges, neobanks, and CFD brokerages fits: I understand the infrastructure layer, stablecoins, custody, payment provider routing and cascading, not just the surface UX.

On the data-led side, I run funnel analysis in SQL as a standard working practice, not as an occasional reporting exercise. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned the analytics platform end to end, redesigning the ETL pipeline with Dagster and dbt and cutting time per data update by 75%. At construct8, my B2B marketplace side project, conversion tracking in SQL is the primary tool for prioritisation decisions. The posting asks for exactly this combination of data fluency and payments domain depth, and I can bring both from day one.

I work well across Engineering, Compliance, Finance, and Commercial stakeholders because I have had to. At EMIL Group I rebuilt a fracturing 18-person delivery organisation into three

stable teams after near-total senior engineer attrition, restoring client trust while shipping the Claims Center from concept to production. At Rohde & Schwarz I redirected platform strategy based on instrumented user workflow data, the UI-led approach recorded zero clicks; the developer-code-first approach increased pipeline runs by 200%. I am used to making the case with evidence rather than opinion, and to moving fast once the evidence is clear.

Dubai is an active target for me, not a relocation compromise: I am an EU citizen with no visa constraints in the EU/EEA, and I am genuinely excited about the pace of payments infrastructure development in the MENA region. The hybrid arrangement, three days in the Dubai office, suits me well.

I would welcome the chance to talk through how my background maps to the specific deposit and withdrawal challenges you are working on.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and owner with 13 years of delivery in regulated industries, anchored by a founded-and-exited Fintech: Kvitt Payment Solutions, a P2P mobile payments product acquired by Sparkasse. Payments is my core domain, funding journeys, disbursements, provider routing, and failed-payment recovery, supplemented by eight years of active crypto-market participation at the infrastructure level. I combine data-led product thinking (SQL, funnel analysis, experimentation) with strong cross-functional delivery track record across engineering, compliance, finance, and commercial teams.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and Fintech: P2P payment product ownership, customer funding journey, deposit and withdrawal flows, payment provider integration, routing and recovery, girocard ecosystem, PSP integration design, KYC and onboarding flows, stored balances and wallet mechanics.

Data-led Product Thinking: funnel and churn analysis, SQL, KPI definition, A/B testing and experimentation, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Product Ownership and Management: requirements engineering, backlog refinement, roadmap ownership, continuous discovery, MVP definition, user research and interviews, A/B testing, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile (Scaled Agile Framework), ART, PI planning, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning.

Engineering Fluency: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Kotlin.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Governance: GDPR (DSGVO), Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps delivery with ArgoCD cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes; developer-code-first strategy increased pipeline runs by 200%. Led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum for the FCAS European AI and data platform.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Introduced Dagster and dbt, saving 75% of time per data update; migrated bare-metal to containers; delivered full UI relaunch and ETL migration. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · B2B INSURANCE SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person org into three stable teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut new-product launch time from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS
2021-2022

Moved research into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA
PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B
PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK
2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-driven conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped three-layer encryption product with sub-two-minute install for enterprise buyers. Later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Lab to investor rounds: owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built mobile group-based P2P payments from zero; acquired by Sparkasse, operated inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · NAMELESS VENTURES

